i. The mountain-tracts of Kābul

In the mountains of Andar-āb, Khwāst, and the Badakh-shānāt, where conifers (archa) flourished, many springs and gentle slopes could be found. However, in the eastern regions of Kābul, the landscape was covered in grass, resembling a beautiful carpet that blanketed the hills, slopes, and valleys. This was mostly būta-kāh grass, which was highly suitable for horses. In the Andijān region, they also spoke of būta-kāh, though the exact reason for this term was unknown to me. In Kābul, it was said that the grass was named so because it grew in tufts (būta, būta). The alps in these mountains were similar to those in Ḥiṣār, Khutlān, Ferghana, Samarkand, and Moghūlistān, all sharing the same mountainous and alpine characteristics. However, the alps in Ferghana and Moghūlistān were unparalleled among the others. In contrast, the mountains of Nijr-aū, Lamghānāt, and Sawād were distinguished by the presence of cypresses, holm-oak, olive, and mastic (Khānjak) and their unique grass.This grass was dense, tall, and not suitable for either horses or sheep. Although these mountains may have appeared less tall than those previously described, they were indeed formidable, with what seemed like gentle slopes proving to be hard rocks, making them impassable for riding. Many animals and birds from Hindustan could be found here, including the parrot, mīna, peacock, lūja (lūkha), ape, nīl-gāu, and hog-deer (kūta-pāī), with some species not even found in Hindustan.

The mountains to the west of Kābul, including Zindān-valley, Ṣūf-valley, Garzawān, and Gharjistān (Gharchastān), were all quite similar. Their meadows were mostly located in the valleys, and they lacked the extensive grassy slopes and tree masses seen in some of the previously described mountains. However, they did have grass suitable for horses. On their flat tops, where crops were grown, there was enough space for horses to gallop. They featured abundant kīyik. The valleys were predominantly strongholds, often steep and inaccessible from above. It was notable that, while other mountains had their fortifications high up, these mountains had theirs below.

Once again, the mountains of Ghūr, Karnūd (var. Kuzūd), and Hazāra were quite similar. Their meadows were in the valleys, and they had few trees, including the absence of conifers. The grass in these regions was suitable for both horses and the numerous sheep they kept. What set them apart from the previously mentioned mountains was that their strongholds were not located below.